



OFFICIAL

NMHS MHS PROCEDURE

Staff and Official Visitors Identification

Scope (Audience)	All NMHS Mental Health Service (MHS) Workers
Scope (Area)	All NMHS MHS Areas
Summary	Procedure outlining NMHS Mental Health Services responsibilities in providing a safe and secure environment within all services. Identification cards are an important security strategy, which assist in maintaining the safety of patients, visitors, staff and property.
Risk Rating	Low
NSQHS Standards	Clinical Governance (Std 1)
Policy Sponsor	Operational Co Director Adult Inpatient MHS
Policy Contact	Operational Co Directors MHS
Version	2.0
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COMPLIANCE WITH THIS DOCUMENT IS MANDATORY

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1. Aim

NMHS Mental Health Services are committed to providing a safe and secure environment within all services. Identification cards are an important security strategy, which assist in maintaining the safety of patients, visitors, staff and property and aligns with the [NMHS Dress Code Policy](#).

2. Risk

Security within Mental Health Services (MHS) facilities is the responsibility of all employees, and identification card are an important security strategy.

Non-compliance with this policy will impact on the following risk categories:

Culture	☐	Organisational Development	☐
Emergency Management	☒	Policy & Legislative Compliance	☒
Fiscal Responsibility	☐	Quality of Patient Care	☐
Governance & Accountability	☐	Research & Innovation	☐
Information Communications Technology	☐	Staff Safety & Wellness	☒
Facility Management	☐	Workforce Planning	☐
Medical Equipment	☐	Other	☐

3. Procedure

3.1 Individuals required to wear an identification card

All individuals accessing MHS services / sites, other than patients and patient visitors, will be issued with and **must always wear an approved identification card**, identifying clearly for patients and staff their name and designation.

All identification cards issued by NMHS or MHS remain the property of the health service.

The following individuals are required to wear photographic identification cards issued by NMHS Security or authorised branch:

- All permanent, fixed term and casual staff

The following individuals are required to wear photographic identification cards issued by their site/service:

- All employees of other organisations who are based within a MHS site / service
- All volunteers of organisations based within MHS sites / services

The following individuals are to wear identification cards (Official Visitor) issued by the relevant MHS site/service:

- Official visitors
- Contractors and service personnel
- Sales representatives
- Consumer consultants

The following individuals are required to wear identification cards issued by their institution / agency;

- All Students.
- Staff engaged by an external employment agency, e.g. agency staff.
- WA Health Staff employed by other health services who are required to attend an MHS site / service as part of their accountabilities.

For specific induction and onboarding requirements for volunteers, contractors, and students. Refer to the [NMHS Volunteer Policy](#) or [NMHS Contractor and Labour Hire Safety Policy](#) for relevant requirements.

Employees are expected to promote the principles of this procedure and to question unidentified persons and report any unsatisfactory explanation or suspect/suspicious behaviour to their Manager and / or Security (if applicable).

3.2 Security issues

Identification cards are to be worn in a prominent clearly visible position, above the waistline. Acceptable means of displaying identification include:

- Clip
- Retractable card reel (worn at waist level only)
- Lanyard with a safety breakaway mechanism for staff who do not have patient contact.

Identification card must not be defaced or tampered with in any way. Individuals issued with identification card must always wear them except where their Manager has authorised otherwise for clinical or occupational health and safety reasons. Where such authorisation has been provided, staff are expected to carry their identification with them so as that it can be produced upon request.

Identification cards must not be left unattended and are to be securely locked away or removed from premises out of office hours.

Lost, found or stolen cards are to be reported as soon as possible to the Manager. Where an access card, attached to the identification card requires replacement, the Manager / Security should be contacted immediately

3.3 Issuing of identification card

3.3.1 Employees

It is the responsibility of the Manager to ensure that new employees complete relevant documentation for the issue of a photographic identification card and keys / access card prior to or on commencement of employment.

Employees can obtain an identification card by completing the appropriate NMHS Security or authorised branch Identification Authorisation Form. The form should be completed and signed by the Manager, then presented in person by the employee to the security department aligned to their relevant site, where a photograph will be taken, and identification card issued.

- Graylands Hospital - [Security Asset Request Form](#)
- Osborne Park Hospital –  [Request for Access and Photographic Identification Card](#)
- Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital –  [Request for Access and Photographic Identification Card](#)

Services not on a co-located hospital site, are to go to the closest NMHS Security or authorised branch;

- Selby Older Adult – Graylands Hospital
- Wanneroo Older Adult Community – Osborne Park Hospital
- Adult Community Mental Health (CMH)
 - Mirrabooka, Osborne, Wanneroo and Butler - Osborne Park Hospital.
 - Subiaco CMH - Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital
- Youth
 - Youth Access - Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital
 - Youth Reach South and Youth Link – Graylands Hospital.

3.3.2 Naming conventions

As a minimum standard, clinical staff and non-clinical staff are required to have their first name and position on their identification card. Inclusion of second name on the identification card is optional.

Identification cards are issued for the exclusive use of the named employee and are not to be loaned.

3.3.3 Official visitors

Official Visitor identification card is to be issued by the Manager (or delegate) of the area for which the visit is related including official visitors, contractors and sales representatives.

All Official Visitors will report to main reception or equivalent at each service. A MHS “*Visitor*” identification card will be issued, and a Visitor Register will be maintained by each MHS.

The register will include as a minimum:

- Name of person(s)
- Position
- Organisation represented
- Contact number
- Date and time attending
- Purpose of visit

MH sites are to be advised of any expected Official Visitor attendances by the relevant Manager who has arranged the visit.

The Official Visitor is also to wear the identification card issued by the company they represent **as well as** the MH Visitor identification card.

Visitor identification cards are the property of MHS and must be returned to point of issue at the end of the visit or assignment.

Visitor Registers are to be retained at each service for seven years after action completed, then destroyed in accordance with [WA Health Information Retention and Disposal Policy](#).

3.3.4 Agency staff

All agency staff will be advised of the designated person to report to at a MHS site.

The designated person will ensure the agency staff are wearing their agency official identification card. Agency staff will sign in on their designated time sheet and then sign out at the end of their shift.

3.3.5 Infection prevention

Identification cards must not be enclosed in a non-porous material cover and must be able to be wiped down with a hospital approved disinfectant wipe that will not affect the card or cover as this may lead to bacteria accumulation.

Note: Despite hand hygiene procedures, identification cards touched by health care worker's hands can recontaminate hands with pathogens. Regular disinfection of identification cards may reduce bacterial pathogen contamination, but ultimately strict hand hygiene is the best way to prevent cross infection

3.3.6 Replacement of identification card

Replacement card will be provided in the following circumstances:

- Loss
- Damage
- Staff name or permanent position change

The Security Department need authorisation from the Manager to issue a replacement card. Staff members may be responsible for the replacement cost of their identification card if it is lost due to carelessness.

3.3.7 Return of identification card

When a permanent, fixed term or casual employee issued with an identification card retires, resigns, is transferred, has their employment terminated or proceeds on an extended leave of more than six months, their identification card is to be returned to the issuing officer.

The Manager is responsible for ensuring identification card are returned to NMHS Security or authorised branch. NMHS Security or authorised branch are to maintain a register of all identification cards issued and returned.

Only when the identification card, and any access devices (keys / swipe cards) and other MH property has been returned the Manager, with the employee, fill in the relevant HCN forms i.e. Termination (T1), Employee Termination Checklist (T4).

4. Monitoring, Compliance and Evaluation

Compliance with this procedure is mandatory. Breach of this procedure may result in disciplinary action under the WA Health Misconduct and Discipline Policy.

Each Manager or service Executive Director is to ensure compliance with this procedure.

This procedure will be evaluated as required to determine its currency, relevance, effectiveness, efficiency, and sustainability. At a minimum, it will be reviewed every 3 years using a risk management approach in accordance with the [NMHS Policy Governance Framework](#).

5. Definitions

Terms	Definitions
Worker	For the purpose of this policy, Worker includes NMHS staff, agency staff, contractors, volunteers, students and persons on work placement/ work experience/unremunerated clinical agreement (UCA)

Refer to [NMHS Policy Document Glossary of Terms](#) for any other frequently used terms

6. Related Documents

Legislation	• Health Services Act 2016 (WA) • Health Services (Information) Regulations 2017 (WA) • State Records Act 2000 (WA)
WA Health mandatory policies	• MP 0124/09 WA Health Code of Conduct Policy • MP 0152/21 WA Health Information Governance Policy
NMHS Policy documents	• NMHS Electronic Security Systems Policy • NMHS Dress Code Policy

7. Document Control

Document Version Control			
Date	Version	Author	Notes
16/02/2022	1.0	A/Policy and Audit Officer MHPHDS	Scheduled review, changed from Policy to Procedure, change of title, include information for official visitors, include information from MH Keys and Swipe Cards Policy, policy framework and NMHS policy.
14/11/2025	2.0	Operational Co Director Adult Inpatient MHS	

This document can be made available in alternative formats on request for a person with a disability.

Within the Department of Health WA, the term Aboriginal is used in preference to Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander, in recognition that Aboriginal people are the original inhabitants of Western Australia. No disrespect is intended to our Torres Strait Islander colleagues and community.

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